BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Sunday 18 Oct 2026, 07:55 Malaysia time (23:55 UTC Sat)

BTC ~ $81,300

Coinbase: -0.4% 24h, -2.0% 7d

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, slight bearish tilt	**Next 24h range:** $80,300 - $82,600	**Key floor:** $80,000 (then $79,000 max pain)	**Big event:** $12.2B monthly expiry Fri 30 Oct; FOMC 29 Oct 02:00 MYT

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

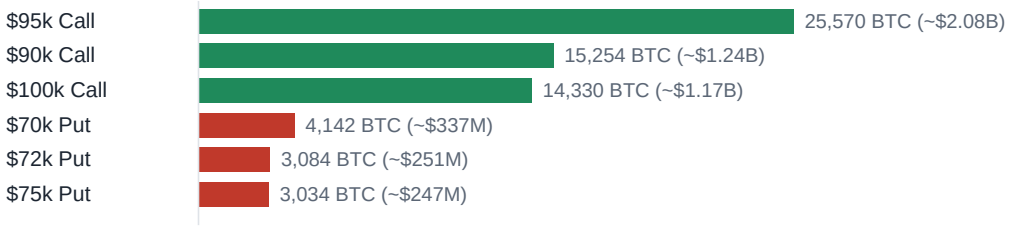
- **Next expiry:** Deribit daily BTC-18OCT26 at **4:00pm MYT today (Sun 18 Oct)**. Weekend dailies are small; strike-level data for it could not be read this run, so treat it as a non-event for price.
- **Next weekly:** Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm MYT - about 13,800-14,800 BTC (~$1.1-1.2B), put-heavy (P/C 1.24), max pain $82,000.
- **The expiry that matters:** monthly Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm MYT - ~149,700 BTC, **~$12.2B** notional, P/C 0.52, max pain **$79,000**. It lands two days after the Fed decision.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
18 Oct daily	n/a (not readable)	small	Weekend daily; too small to steer price
23 Oct weekly	$78,000 put (largest)	part of 7,624 BTC puts	Hedging floor just below $80k; then $70k and $80k puts
23 Oct weekly	Calls total	6,149 BTC (~$500M)	Few calls - little upside fuel; max pain $82k sits just above spot

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Sun 18 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	small / n/a	n/a	n/a	Not readable this run
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.1-1.2B	1.24	$82,000	Puts $78k, $70k, $80k
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.2B	0.52	$79,000	Calls $95k (25,570), $90k (15,254), $100k (14,330); puts $70k (4,142), $72k, $75k
Fri 27 Nov, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$2.2B (26,779 BTC)	n/a	n/a	n/a

30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (BTC; USD at $81,300)



How options affect the market now

- **Today's expiry is noise.** The 4pm daily is small; weekend liquidity is thin, so moves come from spot/perp flow, not options.
- **Weekly pull toward $82,000.** 23 Oct max pain is ~$700 above spot and the book is put-heavy (P/C 1.24). Dealers short those puts tend to buy dips toward $80-78k and sell rallies, which favours chop in $80k-$82.5k into Friday.
- **Monthly gravity is lower: $79,000.** The $12.2B 30 Oct expiry has max pain ~$2,300 below spot. Into late October, that is a mild downward pull if nothing else is driving price.
- **Call walls are far away.** The big $90k/$95k/$100k calls (~$4.5B combined) are deep out of the money; they only matter if BTC rallies past $84k and dealers have to chase hedges - unlikely this week.
- **Downside protection is thin below $78k.** Put OI at $75k/$72k/$70k is modest, so if $78-80k breaks, there is less hedged support and the move can speed up.

- **Volatility:** short-dated IV was ~32% (7-day ATM, 13 Oct), about a 1.7% (~$1,350) daily 1-sigma move. Expect IV to rise into the 28-29 Oct Fed and 30 Oct expiry.

Data note: Deribit API calls (index price, DVOL, book summary) could not be fetched this run, so strike-level figures come from published reports (CryptoTicker 17 Oct, TokenPost 16 Oct, Digital Today 13 Oct). Treat them as 'largest seen'. USD sizes = BTC OI x $81,300. IV figure is from 13 Oct, not live.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC is ~$81,300 (Coinbase), down 0.4% in 24h and 2.0% on the week. Saturday's range was tight: about $81,100-$81,730.
- The week saw a high above $84,000 (rejected near $84,250) and a brief dip below $80,000 after the hot September CPI on 14 Oct.
- Price sits under the 10-EMA (~$82,340) and 20-SMA (~$83,400) but above the 50-period averages (~$80,400-81,300) - a market in a range with a soft downward lean.
- Glassnode notes loss-taking has reappeared, which marked the last three local bottoms - one argument for a floor just above $80,000.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,000-84,250	Weekly high and rejection zone; break opens the way to $87k
Resistance 1	$82,000-82,500	Reclaim level; 23 Oct max pain at $82k; 10-EMA nearby
Pivot	$81,000-81,500	Current balance zone, 50-SMA ~$81,300
Support 1	$80,000	Round number, recent hourly low ~$80,700 and weekly wick below
Support 2	$78,000-79,000	Largest weekly put ($78k) and 30 Oct max pain ($79k)
Deep risk	$75,000 / $70,000	Monthly put strikes; thin hedging below $78k can speed a drop

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Perp funding (8h)	+0.0054%	Near neutral - no crowded longs
Perp open interest	~$65.2B	Elevated; leverage still present
Liquidations (24h, all crypto)	$314.9M, 66% longs	Longs flushed on Friday's dip; BTC ~$59M
Spot BTC ETF flows	16 Oct: -$82.4M (IBIT -$71.8M); 14 Oct: -$261M	Oct month-to-date about -$615M - institutional demand weak
Fear & Greed	40 (Fear)	Cautious, not panicked
Options IV	~32% (7d ATM, 13 Oct)	Low-ish; cheap protection ahead of Fed
Fed pricing	Hold 28 Oct base case; Dec hike ~75-89%	Hiking cycle is the main macro headwind

4. News and macro

- **Hot September CPI (14 Oct):** headline 3.7% y/y (+0.6% m/m), core 2.6% y/y (+0.3% m/m, above 0.2% forecast). It revived Fed hike bets; BTC slid from ~$83.5k.
- **Fed:** funds rate 3.75-4.00% after a September hike. Next decision Wed 28 Oct (02:00 MYT Thu 29 Oct); markets lean hold, with a December hike heavily priced.
- **Risk-off links:** BTC is trading closely with the S&P 500 (correlation cited near 85%); rising oil and a 10-year yield near 5.1% weigh on risk assets.
- **ETF outflows:** spot BTC ETFs have seen about $615M of net outflows in October so far.

- **Adoption/security:** Charles Schwab opened direct BTC/ETH trading to clients; Deutsche Bank preparing institutional custody; Chainalysis-cited reports of a ~$5M theft involving Ledger users.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Sun 18 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily expiry (small)
Wed 21 Oct	AVAX token unlock (3.58M AVAX)
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly expiry (~$1.1-1.2B, max pain $82k)
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am / 2:30am	FOMC decision / Powell press conference
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30pm	US September PCE and Q3 GDP (first estimate)
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry (~$12.2B, max pain $79k)
Tue 3 Nov	US midterm elections
Fri 6 Nov, 9:30pm	US October jobs report

5. Summary and prediction

BTC is drifting in a tight $81k-$82k band on a quiet weekend after a volatile week driven by a hot CPI print and steady ETF outflows. Options positioning points to a sideways-to-slightly-lower market: the 23 Oct weekly has put-heavy hedging around $78-80k with max pain at $82k, while the much larger $12.2B 30 Oct expiry has max pain at $79k and its big call strikes ($90-100k) sit far out of reach. Funding is neutral and sentiment is in Fear (40), so there is no excess leverage to fuel a squeeze, but also no panic. The real catalysts - the Fed on 29 Oct (MYT) and the monthly expiry on 30 Oct - are 11-12 days away, so the next 24 hours should be range-bound with thin weekend liquidity. **24h call: range $80,300-$82,600, bias neutral with a slight downside lean; a clean reclaim of $82,000 or loss of $80,000 decides direction.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: chop	55%	$80,300 - $82,600	Quiet weekend, no macro data; spot pinned between $80k support and $82k max pain
Bullish	20%	$82,500 - $84,300	Hourly close above $82,000 with rising spot volume; ETF inflows return Monday
Bearish	25%	$78,500 - $80,300	Loss of $80,000 on volume; equity futures weak Sunday night / Monday open

- Bull signal: 4-hour close above $82,000-82,500 with funding staying near neutral (spot-led, not leverage-led).
- Bear signal: hourly close below $80,000 - next stops $79,000 (monthly max pain) and $78,000 (largest weekly put).
- Next report: 3:50pm MYT (Sun 18 Oct).

Sources

Coinbase - Bitcoin price page (accessed 18 Oct 2026 MYT): https://www.coinbase.com/price/bitcoin

CryptoTicker - Bitcoin price prediction: $12.2bn of options expire (17 Oct 2026): https://cryptoticker.io/en/bitcoin-options-expiry-october-30-2026-max-pain/

CryptoTicker - Bitcoin options expiry October 16 (15 Oct 2026): https://cryptoticker.io/en/bitcoin-options-expiry-16-october-max-pain/

TokenPost - Bitcoin options open interest reaches $1.15 billion (16 Oct 2026): https://www.tokenpost.com/news/investing/33218

Digital Today - Volatility expectations ease ahead of US CPI (13 Oct 2026): https://www.digitaltoday.co.kr/en/view/113628/bitcoin-volatility-expectations-ease-ahead-of-us-cpi-put-bets-build-below-80000

Au79 Macro Research - 17Oct2026 Crypto & Macro-Liquidity (17 Oct 2026): https://martyau79.substack.com/p/17oct2026-crypto-and-macro-liquidity

Koin Bulteni - Market overview (17 Oct 2026): https://koinbulteni.com/en/bitcoin-and-altcoins-market-overview-october-17-2026-290225.html

Bitcoin.com News - Bitcoin price at $81,500 leaves bulls and bears at a standoff (17 Oct 2026): https://news.bitcoin.com/market-updates/bitcoin-price-at-81500-leaves-bulls-and-bears-at-a-standoff/

Investing.com - Bitcoin holds above $81,000 as ETF outflows weigh (17 Oct 2026): https://www.investing.com/news/cryptocurrency-news/bitcoin-price-holds-above-81000-as-etf-outflows-weigh-on-sentiment-4955253

Crypto Times - US CPI live (14 Oct 2026): https://www.cryptotimes.io/2026/10/14/us-cpi-live-inflation-data-bitcoin-price-fed-rate-discussion/

Admiral Markets - Fed rate decision October 2026: https://admiralmarkets.com/analytics/traders-blog/fed-rate-decision-october-2026

CoinGabbar - Why is Bitcoin price down today (17 Oct 2026): https://www.coingabbar.com/en/why-bitcoin-price-down-today-three-macro-pressures-to-watch

Bitcoin Foundation - Bitcoin tests $82,000 (17 Oct 2026): https://bitcoinfoundation.org/news/analysis/bitcoin-tests-82-000-as-btc-price-prediction-hinges-on-a-weekend-reclaim/